

Meoncross School History Department

YEAR 9 SCHEME OF WORK (2026-2027)

Curriculum Planning & Lesson Companion

Key Stage 3 Curriculum Intent & Pedagogical Architecture

1. Curriculum Rationale & Local Maritime Heritage

Our Key Stage 3 history curriculum is intentionally constructed to link national and global historical narratives with the distinctive maritime geography and lived environment of Meoncross pupils. From the industrial revolution of the Fareham ironmaster (Henry Cort at Funtley) to the strategic supremacy of Portsmouth Royal Dockyard and the profound sacrifices recorded on the Stubbington village war memorials, history is made tangible, relevant, and deeply rooted in our coastal community.

2. Disciplinary Progression & Historical Enquiry

Across Years 7, 8, and 9, disciplinary thinking progresses sequentially to secure the foundational skills required for GCSE excellence:

- **Chronological Rigour & Global Encounters:** De-centering traditional anglocentric narratives by examining early global trade, Indigenous perspectives in Australia, and African resistance to the Transatlantic Slave Trade alongside British social transformations.
- **Causation & Consequence:** Moving from simple direct triggers in Year 7 to evaluating multi-tiered, long-term geopolitical catalysts (e.g. European alliance systems, naval arms races).
- **Source Utility & Forensic Evidence:** Progressing from basic comprehension to rigorous interrogation of provenance, evaluating authorial motive, audience, and historical reliability.
- **Historiographical Debate:** Engaging pupils with active academic debates (e.g., assessing the Magna Carta, or challenging the 'Lions led by Donkeys' narrative of the Great War) grounded in historical evidence.

3. Adaptive Teaching, Dual Coding & Inclusion

Pupils work through bespoke printed A4 workbooks closely paired with our digital learning portal. Standardized 3-tier scaffolding (Bronze sentence starters, Silver connectives, Gold historiographical analysis), consistent dual coding, and digital accessibility features offload working memory, ensuring all SEND and lower-attaining pupils achieve ambitious historical progress with zero cognitive overload.

KS3: Causes of the Great War

Year 9 | How did decades of imperial rivalry and fear culminate in thirty days of madness?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 1 How was the German Empire created in 1871?	• Describe how Otto von Bismarck used military force and political manipulation to unify Germany into a powerful empire by 1871 • Explain how the creation of the German Empire shifted the balance of power in Europe and created tension with existing empires • Evaluate the significance of German unification as a long-term cause of the First World War	• Extended Writing (PEEL)
Lesson 2 How did the Franco-Prussian War create a lasting legacy of hatred?	• Identify the penalties forced upon France in 1871. • Explain how the Ems Telegram sparked the Franco-Prussian War. • Evaluate the long-term impact on European relations.	• Structured Paragraph

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 3 To what extent did the 'Scramble for Africa' increase tension in Europe?	- Identify the main European colonial powers and their territories. - Explain how Kaiser Wilhelm II's 'Place in the Sun' policy threatened Britain. - Evaluate the impact of the Moroccan Crises on the Entente Cordiale.	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 4 Why did a battleship building contest destroy Anglo-German relations?	- Identify the significance of the HMS Dreadnought. - Explain the concept of the Two-Power Standard and Risk Theory. - Analyze how naval competition fed mutual suspicion.	Analytical Essay
Lesson 5 Did the Alliance System protect Europe or guarantee a global war?	- Identify the members of the Triple Alliance and the Triple Entente. - Explain why countries felt the need to form secret defensive treaties. - Evaluate how the alliance system could drag all of Europe into a regional conflict.	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 6 Why did a single assassination in Sarajevo ignite a World War?	- Identify the events of 28 June 1914. - Explain how the assassination triggered the alliance system. - Analyze whether the resulting war was inevitable or accidental.	Structured Paragraph
Lesson 7 End of Unit Assessment: The Historians' Debate	<i>Historical Enquiry</i>	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>

Unit Key Vocabulary: Alsace-Lorraine • Ems Telegram • Reparations • Siege • Imperialism • Scramble for Africa • Empire • Colony • Dreadnought • Arms Race • Two-Power Standard • Naval Supremacy • Triple Entente • Triple Alliance • Reinsurance Treaty • Encirclement • Assassination • Black Hand • Ultimatum • Mobilisation

KS3: The Great War (1914–1919)

Year 9 | How did a single spark in Sarajevo ignite a global conflict that transformed the modern world?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 1 Why were young men so desperate to join the slaughter of 1914?	- Describe how propaganda, imperial loyalty, and alliance obligations drove mass enlistment across the British Empire - Explain why trench warfare on the Western Front created a devastating stalemate - Evaluate the extent to which soldiers' expectations of war matched the reality of industrial-scale conflict	- PEEL Paragraph (Source Utility): Explain why so many young British men eagerly volunteered for the army in 1914. - Evaluating Primary Evidence - Extended Writing (PEEL)
Lesson 2 Did British generals make the horror of trench warfare worse?	- Describe the key features of trench warfare and explain why it caused such devastating casualties - Explain the debate around British military leadership: were generals incompetent or facing impossible circumstances? - Evaluate the significance of propaganda in shaping public perception of the war effort	- PEEL Paragraph (Source Utility): Explain why the conditions in the trenches were so difficult for soldiers. - Interrogating Historical Sources - Structured Paragraph

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 3 How much of a 'World' War was it, and why were the Empire's troops forgotten?	- Describe the contribution of soldiers from across the British Empire, including troops from India, Africa, and the Caribbean - Explain why the contributions of imperial and colonial troops were marginalised in traditional British narratives of the war - Evaluate the significance of protest and resistance movements that emerged from colonial soldiers' wartime experiences	- PEEL Paragraph (Source Utility): Explain why the contribution of Empire troops was so important to the British war effort. - Primary Source Analysis - Exam Practice Writing
Lesson 4 How did a war fought miles away completely control daily life in Britain?	- Describe the key features of the Home Front, including rationing, propaganda, and the role of women in industry - Explain how the war expanded the power of Parliament and challenged traditional ideas about democracy and gender - Evaluate the significance of the war as a catalyst for social and political change in Britain	- PEEL Paragraph (Source Utility): Explain how the Defence of the Realm Act (DORA) changed everyday life in Britain. - Working with Contemporary Accounts
Lesson 5 Did the Treaty of Versailles solve the problems of 1914, or create the nightmares of 1939?	- Describe the key terms of the Treaty of Versailles and the competing aims of the Allied powers - Explain why the treaty created new tensions through trade restrictions, territorial changes, and the War Guilt Clause - Evaluate whether the Treaty of Versailles represented genuine change or simply planted the seeds for future conflict	- PEEL Paragraph (Source Utility): Explain why the Treaty of Versailles caused so much resentment in Germany. - Evaluating Primary Evidence - Extended Writing (PEEL)
Lesson 6 How did the "Lost Generation" impact the village of Stubbington?	- Describe the local impact of the Great War on communities like Stubbington, using evidence from war memorials and Church records - Explain the significance of the concept of the 'Lost Generation' for understanding the war's long-term social consequences - Evaluate primary sources (war memorials, photographs, local records) to construct a historically grounded account of local impact	- PEEL Paragraph (Source Utility): Explain the impact of the First World War on local communities like Stubbington. - Interrogating Historical Sources
Lesson 7 Assessment: The Great War	- Synthesise knowledge of trench warfare, the Home Front, imperial contributions, propaganda, and the Treaty of Versailles - Construct a sustained argument using specific evidence about the causes, course, and consequences of the Great War - Evaluate historical interpretations of the war, including the 'Lions led by Donkeys' debate	Historical Interpretations: Historical Interpretations: General Haig

KS3: The Shoah

Year 9 | How did a modern, civilized nation commit the systematic murder of six million Jewish people?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 1 Anti-Semitism: How did centuries of prejudice pave the way for Nazi ideology?	<i>Historical Enquiry</i>	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 2 1933–1939: How were German Jews progressively stripped of citizenship and rights?	<i>Historical Enquiry</i>	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 3 The Ghettos and the Einsatzgruppen: How did persecution turn into systematic mass murder?	<i>Historical Enquiry</i>	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 4 The 'Final Solution': How did the death camps operate as industrialised extermination?	<i>Historical Enquiry</i>	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 5 Resistance, Rescue, and Complicity: Did anyone stand up to the perpetrators?	<i>Historical Enquiry</i>	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 6 Liberation and Legacy: What does survivor testimony teach us about humanity and memory?	<i>Historical Enquiry</i>	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 7 Assessment: The Shoah Enquiry	<i>Historical Enquiry</i>	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>

KS3: The Cold War

Year 9 | Why did the ideological clash between Capitalism and Communism bring the world to the brink of nuclear destruction?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 1 Ideological Clash: Why could Capitalism and Communism never peacefully coexist?	<i>Historical Enquiry</i>	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 2 Yalta to Potsdam (1945): How did wartime allies become bitter rivals?	<i>Historical Enquiry</i>	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 3 The Iron Curtain & The Berlin Blockade (1948–1949): The first flashpoint.	<i>Historical Enquiry</i>	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 4 Nuclear Brinkmanship: The Cuban Missile Crisis (1962).	<i>Historical Enquiry</i>	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 5 Proxy Wars: Why did the superpowers fight in Asia (Korea & Vietnam)?	<i>Historical Enquiry</i>	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 6 Fall of the Berlin Wall (1989) and the collapse of the Soviet Union (1991).	<i>Historical Enquiry</i>	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 7 Assessment: Was the Cold War ever truly 'cold'?	<i>Historical Enquiry</i>	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>

KS3: Rights, Protest, and Post-War Britain (1900–Present)

Year 9 | How has British identity transformed since 1945?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 1 Votes for Women: Were the Suffragists or Suffragettes more effective in securing the vote?	<i>Historical Enquiry</i>	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 2 1945: How did the aftermath of total war build the Welfare State and the NHS?	<i>Historical Enquiry</i>	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 3 The Windrush Generation: Why did Britain invite Commonwealth citizens, and what did they face?	<i>Historical Enquiry</i>	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 4 The 1963 Bristol Bus Boycott & the fight for British civil rights.	<i>Historical Enquiry</i>	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 5 The Cold War on the Home Front: How did nuclear paranoia shape British popular culture?	<i>Historical Enquiry</i>	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 6 Assessment: How has British identity transformed since 1945?	<i>Historical Enquiry</i>	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>